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Dubai Media Office

EGYPTIAN, 11, CROWNED ARAB READING CHALLENGE CHAMPION

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, yesterday crowned Mayar Othman Al Shuorbagy, an 11-year-old Egyptian student who beat more than 40 million students from 60 countries, as the champion of the 10th Arab Reading Challenge. **SEE ALSO P4**

8 jailed for life over Sudan Army weapons supply

ABU DHABI COURT ORDERS DEPORTATION OF CONVICTS AFTER PRISON TERM

ABU DHABI

The Abu Dhabi Federal Court of Appeal has brought the case of an illicit weapons and ammunition trafficking and money laundering network to a close, convicting several defendants in a case that revealed a network in which arms deals, commercial companies, bank transfers and cash payments were intertwined in the supply of weapons, ammunition and military equipment to the Sudanese Army and the concealment of the true nature, sources and destinations of the funds.

Those sentenced to life imprisonment are Rashid Omar Abdul Qadir Ali; Salah Abdullah Mohammed Mohammed Saleh, known as Salah Gosh; Ahmed Abdullah, known as Abdullah Khalafallah; Ahmed Rabie' Sayed Ahmed; Mohammed Fath Al Beik; Yasser Abdulrahman Al Atta; Othman Al Zubair; and Maher Abdul Jalil. The court also ordered the confiscation of the seized ammunition, mobile phones and communications devices used in the crime, and the deportation of those convicted from the UAE after serving their sentences.

The court further sentenced Rashid Omar Abdul Qadir Ali; Salah Abdullah Mohammed Mohammed Saleh, known as Salah Gosh; Ahmed Abdullah, known as Abdullah Khalafallah; Maher Abdul Jalil Mohammed Abdul Jalil; Othman Babiker; Khalid Yousuf Mukhtar; and Ahmed Khalafallah Abdullah to three years' imprisonment each. Those subject to fines were also ordered to pay Dh1 million each for the offence of money laundering.

The court ordered the confiscation of Dh1.545 million from the seized funds and the deportation of the convicted individuals after serving their sentences.

Companies fined

The court also fined each of the following companies Dh1 million for money laundering: Rashed Omar Brokerage Company; Portex Trade Limited; Apollara Electronics Trading Company; Yellow Sand Trading Company; Wardat Al Masarra Trading Company; and Sudamina – Free Zone. It further ordered the cancellation of their licences and registrations and the confiscation of funds under attachment and proceeds derived from the money laundering offence.

Mubarak Ali Al Sheikh and Mus'ab Awad Al Karim Hassan were acquitted of the charges brought against them.

The grounds of the judgment established that the defendants had traded in weapons, ammunition and military equipment without a licence or authorisation from the competent authority. *— WAM*



FRIDAY MAGAZINE

Celebrate Diwali and Dhanteras with fashion that shines differently

VIEWS

AI's kill switch: Businesses need more than a stop button | P5



IN FOCUS

UAE in Nov: New rules, Etihad Rail stations, road changes, events | P8-9

UAE urges dialogue to avert escalation of regional tensions

Reaffirms resolve to settle disputes peacefully

ABU DHABI
Gulf News Report

In light of the delicate circumstances facing the region, the UAE affirmed that dialogue and adherence to international law are essential to addressing the ongoing crises. This reflects the UAE's steadfast commitment to resolving disputes through diplomatic and peaceful means. In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) reiterated the UAE's call to exercise wisdom and pursue political solutions to help contain tensions, prevent further escalation, safeguard regional security and stability, and promote development and prosperity for the region's people.

The Ministry emphasised the need to intensify diplomatic efforts and coordinate with regional and international partners to support efforts to resolve crises and strengthen peace and stability, in line with the aspirations of the region's people for a safer and more prosperous future.

The UAE statement came as US Vice President JD Vance proposed direct peace talks with Iran in a letter delivered through Qatari mediators, offering to lead negotiations as early as next week in Qatar or Turkey, *The New York Times* reported.

The newspaper reported that Iranian leaders had received the proposal positively.

SEE ALSO P6



ABU DHABI

A taste of Abu Dhabi in Calgary as Etihad brings two cultures together | P-II

Etihad Credit Bureau launches Score 3i model

New model extends credit behaviour assessment period from 24 to 36 months

ABU DHABI
BY HAMNA IQBAL
Reporter

Etihad Credit Bureau has launched Credit Score 3i, an enhanced scoring model designed to provide a more comprehensive assessment of individuals' credit behaviour and support informed financial decisions in the UAE.

The new model extends the credit behaviour assessment period from 24 to 36 months, providing better insights into repayment patterns and financial obligations. It also expands eligibility to individuals who are new to credit or new to the UAE and have limited credit histories.

Credit Score 3i introduces two scoring ranges: 300–850 for individuals with established credit histories and 300–650 for eligible individuals with limited credit histories. The model may reflect improvements in credit behaviour within six months of settling defaults, depending on subsequent repayment behaviour, the individual's overall credit profile, and the model's criteria. However, score improvements during this period are not guaranteed, and subsequent negative credit events may affect progress.

Responsible credit practices

"The new model advances the use of data and analytics to support more comprehensive credit risk assessments, strengthen financial sector efficiency and encourage responsible credit practices," said Marwan Ahmad Lutfi, Director General of Etihad Credit Bureau.

Residents can check scores at etihadbureau.ae or via the mobile app, subject to verification and any fees.

SEE ALSO PI

The new model expands eligibility to individuals who are new to credit or new to the UAE and have limited credit histories.



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